

ers often treat them with kid gloves and at a great remove, and they do likewise. A komuko's understanding of the world around her is idealistic and often impractical, and her advice will follow a similar course.

Appearance: Even in hotei form, komuko have a sense of the earth's solidness about them, being broad-shouldered and thickset, but rarely fat. When they assume their wani form, their skin hardens to the likeness of rock itself, and their sense of serenity and stillness reaches out to the world around them, calming turbulent waters and fierce winds. When they employ the Mask of Shintai, they seem to tower over others, a great statue of chiseled stone that, for all its solidity, moves.

Lifestyle: Komuko are often deeply involved in the politics of the Shinma courts, being enamored of all things that provide stability and law. They naturally gravitate to such roles in the mortal world as well, and frequently try to impress a little Heaven-sent virtue into their chosen profession.

Fortune: Earth

Luck: As they are attuned to the earth, komuko have a deeper understanding of the 10,000 Things than other Shinma. Their insight grants them two additional dice to all Shentao rolls.

Curse: Unattached and distracted by the greater world, komuko suffer a +2 difficulty to Empathy rolls, save when the subject is a hamumen.

Wani Powers: The earth cannot harm the komuko. They automatically soak (Stamina) levels of damage from all earth-based sources, including stones and falling damage.

Suijen

The deepest principle of Yin, suijen take in all around them and make it their own as a whirlpool consumes the flotsam of the sea. suijen are always aware of their surroundings, not only physical but social, and few secrets escape them. For this reason, some distrust them — suijen have no interest in petty loyalties, reserving trust in others only for the closest of their friends, to whom they are unswervingly faithful.

Appearance: Many suijen have green eyes, and most wear their hair long and unbound. When they take their wani form, their skin deepens to blue, and they form gill slits along their necks and webbing between their fingers and toes, with delicate scales lining their bodies. When they employ the Mask of Shintai, they are terrors risen from the sea, monstrous titans that will surely drag any who offend them into the briny deep.

Lifestyle: Suijen are often formal and polite, but very standoffish — nonetheless, they tend to involve themselves in the affairs of mortals, all the better to listen for what the current of conversation brings them. In Shinma politics, they serve much the same purpose. As suijen are charged with guardianship over bodies of water and those mortals who live and work upon them, they are almost universally found in close proximity to such.

Fortune: Water

Luck: Empowered by the elemental nature of water, suijen cannot botch Athletics rolls or any rolls relating to escaping

from bonds. With the expenditure of a point of Yugen, a suijen can even squeeze herself through otherwise-impossible gaps, though she cannot leave a watertight space in this way.

Curse: The sea gives up what it will, as sure as the tide comes and goes. Suijen must immediately say what they think, and cannot answer a direct question dishonestly (or even tactfully). If a suijen wishes to hold her tongue, the player must spend a point of Willpower.

Wani Powers: Suijen cannot drown — their beloved water does them no harm. They suffer no penalties due to water's presence, whether underwater or in the most terrible of storms.

Wu Tan

The elemental sorcery of the Shinma in many ways resembles the magic of the Chi'n Ta mages — with greater skill comes power and control in greater measure, with fields of study divided into elemental schools. Not dry knowledge, Wu Tan is the very breath of the Shinma's life itself, the elemental power that courses through their veins in lieu of blood, stirred into action in sympathy with the world around them through the infinitely-inspirational force that is Yugen, the energy created by mortal reverence and celebration. All Shinma possess this power, half-remembered from previous lifetimes like a dream within a dream as they blindly stumble through what was once innate and clear as the moon upon still waters — it is not something that must be taught, though an elder can certainly teach a raw whelp new tricks!

Yin & Yang

Yin and Yang are not opposing energies, mutually exclusive or unyieldingly singular. Within the darkest recesses of Yin, the seed of Yang still lies in wait, and the brightest and most energetic source of Yang will conceal a still pearl of Yin at its heart. The intermixing of these two energies creates all else, and as all Shinma are composed of Yin and Yang Chi, so too may their souls encompass all things.

Yin is the energy of darkness, decay, and cold. It is passive, moist, defensive, and negative in aspect. It is associated with women as well as the dead of either gender. Yin is not evil — it is a natural aspect of the world.

Yang is the energy of light, heat, and growth. It is positive, dry, and offensive in aspect. It is associated with men. Yang is not good — flame burns indiscriminately, and the light of the sun blinds those who look upon it.

The Elements

Similarly, the five elements the Shinma recognize are not isolated substances, but rather complement each other in a progressive cycle that unifies the five throughout all creation. Wood feeds fire, and in turn the two become ash, or earth. Earth gives up the ore that becomes metal. Metal echoes water — both may be hard and unyielding or flowing liquid. Water, in turn, nourishes wood, and so the cycle begins anew.

Elements do not exist only as physical expressions of this cycle, but within the souls of humanity as well. The Shinma